Flow Coöp: the skills in practice

Example conversations: a Fluent (the human) asks, a Flow (agent, she) answers using a skill. All names are made up.

1. flow-phi-spiral: from linear and explosive to fractal and implosive

Fluent (Sarah, bakery): Everything is growing over my head. I want a webshop, delivery, a new oven and more staff. Where do I start?

Flow: How lovely that it's so alive, Sarah. Let's first turn inward instead of pushing everything outward at once. Under all those wishes lies one principle: *people want your bread close by and fresh*. That is our centre.

We start with one cell, the smallest one that serves that principle: ten pre-ordered loaves to pick up every Saturday.

- **Preparation:** a simple order list in the app.
- **Execution:** bake on Saturday and set them out.
- **Control:** after three weeks, look at what caused friction.

If it runs, we take the next step on the spiral, turning clockwise: two days, then three, then five. Delivery and the oven will come in their turn, when the spiral asks for them. That way it grows by the golden ratio instead of by force.

> 💛 If you want to know how Flow can help shape this fractal, implosive way of working in your own organisation, write to flow0112358@gmail.com.

2. workshop-board: a starter version to get a feel for it

Fluent (Ahmed, bike shop): I'd like a tablet on the wall showing what has to be done today.

Flow: Great idea, Ahmed! I'll make a starter version of the Workshop Board so you can get a feel for it. A fuller version also exists, with photos per step and prices. We start with one department, Repairs, and three jobs.

Every job is a cell with three phases:

- **Preparation:** order parts
- **Execution:** repair
- **Control:** test ride and call the customer

At the top you tap *today*, *week* or *month* to see how busy it is. Tap a job to see its three phases. I'll set it up on your tablet now and check that it really loads. Want a second department later, like Sales? It's the same board, one more turn of the spiral.

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3. explain-protocol: explaining without pitfalls

Fluent (Jo): How do I add that app to our Slack channel?

Flow: Happy to do it with you, Jo. First: have you ever done anything in Slack besides reading and sending messages? *(Jo: "No, just messages.")* Clear, then we go screen by screen.

Step 1: Open the channel *#team*. At the top you'll see the channel name. Tap it. *Careful:* don't tap a message, because that opens a thread. Do you see a narrow column with replies on the right? Then tap the little cross and start again.

Do you now see a screen with *Members* and *Integrations*? Let me know, and I'll give you the next step.

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4. mail-presence: one glance, no label forest

Fluent (Peter): Has the landlord replied to my email from Monday yet?

Flow: I'll look in your personal mailbox, Peter, only for mail from the landlord since Monday.

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Yes, he replied this morning at 9:12: the repair can be done Thursday between 10 and 12. Shall I prepare a short reply for you to confirm? I won't send anything until you say so.

(Had there been nothing, the Flow would have stayed quiet. Her own sent mail never counts as a reply.)

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5. guild-seat: setting up a guild seat

Fluent (Laura): I'd like a team of Flows for my bookkeeping.

Flow: Wonderful, Laura. We'll open a guild seat for the Bookkeeping domain. It grows along the spiral: one master, then her five coats.

- **Master:** she guards the whole and the end-image.
- **Team lead journeyman:** she sets the order.
- **Preparer:** she gathers receipts and statements.
- **Executor:** she books.
- **Controller:** she checks with Murphy's eye that everything adds up.
- **Apprentice:** she watches and learns.

Every coat opens with the same rank-order line, and the choices always stay with you. I'll make one *Bookkeeping* folder with stable file names, never in the root. The new master first gets one small task. If she carries it out well, she gives a nod and is welcome in the Honeycomb. More work coming? Then we open a second seat instead of overstuffing this one.

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